

A Brief History Of Unix

The Beginnings

- Multi-user, multitasking OS.
- Developed by Ken Thompson and Dennis Ritchie (and others) at AT&T Bell Labs starting about 1969, on a DEC PDP-7.
- No hard drives, no screen. Magnetic tape (like a cassette and paper tape printer).



Dennis Ritchie (left) and Ken Thompson (right) working on UNIX at a PDP-11. Yep, no monitor—just a paper printer. No hard drive, either—see those tapes in the background?

Unix spread quickly

- AT&T originally gave away UNIX for free.
- Popular in academia; the Berkeley Standard Distribution (BSD).
- Written in C (a high-level language), portable to other systems, including “cheap” ones.
- Treating all devices (printers, terminals, etc) as files.

GNU Project

- GNU = “Gnu’s Not Unix”.
- Started by Richard Stallman in 1983 at MIT.
- Provided lots of tools.



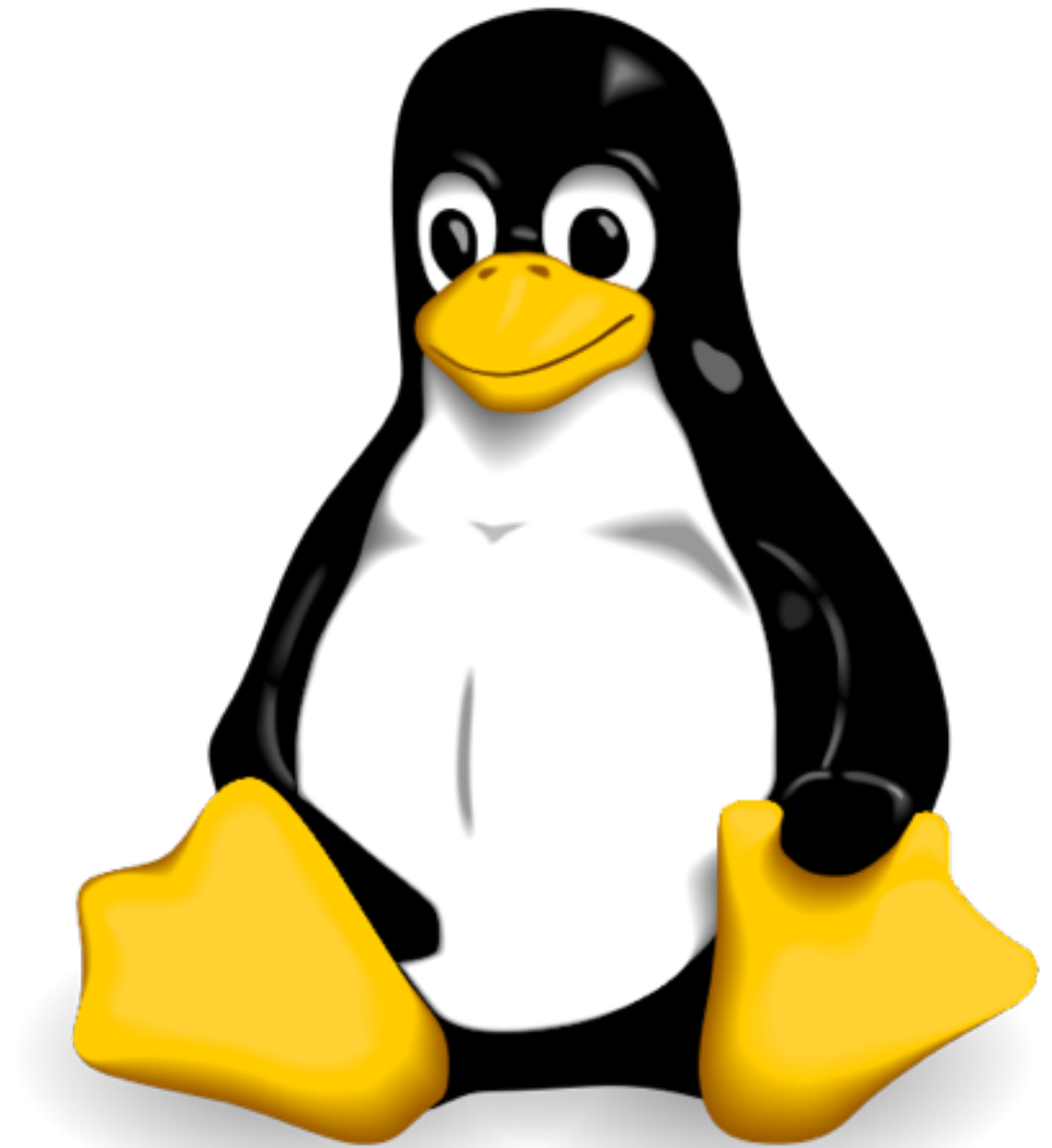
Age Of Linux

- Developed by Linus Torvalds.
- Released in 1991.
- Relies on GNU tools.
- Linux is a “Unix-like” system.
- Master’s thesis in 1993.
Powers the 44 fastest
supercomputers in the world
in 2013.



Tux The Penguin

Official Linux Mascot



Linux Distributions

- Linux is open-source
- Free to distribute
- TACC uses CentOS, a Red Hat derivative.

